

Syllabus

School of Business and Economics

Bachelor's Thesis Econometrics and Operations Research (2025-2026-003- EBT0003)

EBT0003

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Teaching staff

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Table of Contents

Teaching staff	3
About the course	5
To My Timetable	6
Introduction	6
Course Objectives	6
Course Structure	6
Course Schedule and Deadlines	6
Assessment and Grading	6
Validity of Partial Grades and Registration	7
Irregularities, Fraud, and Plagiarism	8
Comments, Exam Inspection, and Appeal	8
Student Code of Conduct	9
Global Citizenship Education and Competency Development	11
Support	13
Resources	14

About the course

During this semester you are going to write your bachelor thesis, which is the final piece of work within the BSc programme Econometrics & Operations Research. You will work on an individual research project under the guidance of a supervisor and demonstrate that you can apply the knowledge and skills that you have obtained throughout your studies.

The topics you will work on will be from one of the disciplines that are part of the programme

Actuarial Sciences,

Econometrics,

Mathematical Economics, and

Operations Research.

The disciplinary courses that you will follow in period 4 will prepare you for the thesis work and their content should also guide in your topic choices.

△ This Canvas course is carefully filled with all necessary information. When unexpected differences occur between Canvas and Student Portal, the information provided in Student Portal is leading.

Student: you can find course descriptions, objectives and ECTS credits via <https://code.unimaas.nl/>.

To My Timetable

[My Timetable \(https://studentportal.maastrichtuniversity.nl/group/guest/my-timetable\)](https://studentportal.maastrichtuniversity.nl/group/guest/my-timetable)

Introduction

The bachelor thesis is the final piece of work that you will do in order to graduate from the BSc Programme Econometrics & Operations Research. You will be able to demonstrate that you can apply the knowledge and skills that you have obtained by working on a research problem from a specific domain. The bachelor thesis is worth 10.5 ECTS.

Course Objectives

- Objective 1: Conduct proper academic research, i.e., students have to develop a reasonable research question, choose appropriate techniques to tackle the formulated research problem, analyse the results of those methods and interpret the results of their research and discuss academic, managerial and ethical implications
- Objective 2: Write a comprehensive academic thesis in one of the research disciplines of the programme
- Objective 3: Present goals and results of their research to expert audience as well as to non- specialists

Course Structure

Students have (individual) meetings with their supervisor(s). The bachelor thesis consists of three assessments: an intermediate presentation, the final poster presentation and the written thesis.

Course Schedule and Deadlines

13.03. Deadline to submit thesis preferences

20.03. Topic allocation

6-8.05. Intermediate Presentations

24.06. Final Poster presentations

26.06. Deadline to hand in final thesis

24.07 Deadline to hand in resit final thesis

<https://timetable.maastrichtuniversity.nl>

Assessment and Grading

The bachelor thesis will be evaluated as outlined below. In order to successfully finish your bachelor thesis, you have to satisfy three components.

1. Intermediate presentation (10% of the final grade)
2. Final presentation (10% of the final grade)
3. Bachelor thesis (80% of the grade)

The bachelor thesis will be graded by two assessors. Each assessor's grade will contribute to 40% of your final grade. Your presentations and thesis will be assessed using the rubrics that you can find on Canvas.

Passing requirement: In order to pass the bachelor thesis, all four grades that you obtain must be at least 5.5.

Resit opportunity: If you do not finish any of the above components by the deadline, you have the opportunity to participate in the resit.

-If you did not give an intermediate or final presentation session, or if you presented but your presentation was not graded with at least 5.5, you have to give a respective resit presentation to your supervisor.

-If you did not upload your thesis by the deadline, or if your thesis was graded with a mark less than 5.5, you can submit your revised version of the thesis until the resit deadline. In this case, please take the feedback given by the two assessors into account when preparing a new version of the thesis.

Important: in all of the above cases, it is your responsibility to contact your supervisor well in advance as scheduling an additional presentation or additional meetings during the summer may not be possible at all times.

Validity of Partial Grades and Registration

If you have to redo (a) component(s) of the course in the next academic year you have to:

1. Register for the exam only (in case you have failed the written examination but have passed other parts of the course). In principle, passed partial requirements (components) of the course will remain valid in the academic year in which the partial results are obtained and two (2) more academic years. In exceptional cases, it is within the Board of Examiners' competence to determine otherwise. The final grade will be calculated using the weights that were used in the academic year in which you followed the course.
2. Register for education. If you decide to register for tutorials, you will get new grades for those grades that are assessed during the tutorial meetings (e.g., participation, presentation).

In case you have not passed the final written examination and you have not passed all other partial requirements of the course, you may register for the "education" option next academic year. That is, you follow the course again and re-take all examination components again, including partial requirements such as participation, hand-in exercises, etc.

Note that you have to register for the option that applies to you during next academic year. Keep an eye on registration deadlines.

Irregularities, Fraud, and Plagiarism

In order to protect the reputation of the degrees that you – as students – receive, instances of cheating, fraud or plagiarism (together called 'irregularities') are treated extremely seriously.

Fraud including plagiarism, is understood as a student's act or failure to act that makes it partially or fully impossible to correctly assess their knowledge, insight and skills. Plagiarism is understood as the presentation of one's own or other people's ideas or words without adequate reference to the source. Submitting work or assignments acquired from or written by a third party and/or generated by artificial intelligence software (such as ChatGPT) is considered fraud. Any assignment is an individual piece of work, which means that plagiarism is strictly forbidden. Equally, the use of mobile phones, communication devices, laptops, books, or any other information carrier (whether the phone or other device is turned on or off, used or not used, etc. is irrelevant) during an examination is also forbidden. Please make sure to read and respect the Rules of Procedure for Examinations.

Please keep in mind (unless stated otherwise in writing):

- Individual assignments: These assignments should be executed individually and independently. This also applies to individual take-home examinations.
- Group assignments: All group members are jointly responsible for the assignment. It is not allowed to collaborate and/or share your group assignment with other groups within your course.

If the Board of Examiners concludes that an irregularity, fraud and/or plagiarism has occurred in an examination, they may take appropriate measures or impose sanctions in accordance with SBE's policy on fraud, including plagiarism.

More information can be found in the SBE BSc and MSc EER and on MySBE Intranet:

<https://intranet.maastrichtuniversity.nl/en/fraud-and-plagiarism>

Comments, Exam Inspection, and Appeal

If you want to comment on the exam content, inspect your exam and/or lodge an appeal, there are procedures in place.

Comments

If you have comments about the examination itself (for example an incorrectly formulated question, missing information, or doubts about answer choices), you can submit these to the course coordinator via [ExamComments](http://examcomments.sbe.maastrichtuniversity.nl/) (<http://examcomments.sbe.maastrichtuniversity.nl/>) within five working days after the day of the exam.

Exam inspection

If you would like to have clarification about the outcome of the examination, you can participate in the exam inspection procedure. The exam inspection takes place within ten working days after the publication of your examination results. Your course coordinator will inform you when and how you can do this (usually via the course page in Canvas).

If you remain of the opinion that the assessment is not justified, you may lodge an appeal with the Board of Appeal for Examinations via the [Complaint Service Point \(https://www.maastrichtuniversity.nl/support/during-your-studies/complaints-service-point/filing-complaint\)](https://www.maastrichtuniversity.nl/support/during-your-studies/complaints-service-point/filing-complaint) within six weeks' time after the date of the decision. Please note that we expect that you only submit an appeal once you have completed the rest of the above-mentioned procedures. The appeal procedure is explained below.

Appeal procedure

You may lodge an appeal with the Board of Appeal for Examinations via the Complaint Service Point against:

- Decisions as mentioned in the Education and Examination Regulations (for example the Binding Study Advice or admission procedures)
- Decisions of the Board of Examiners
- Decisions of Examiners.

You may only appeal if a decision has gone directly against your interests.

Good to know

- If you can demonstrate that you are not able to take part in the inspection procedure within the specified period due to circumstances beyond your control, please contact the course coordinator within 5 days after the date of inspection.
- Next to the appeal procedure, it is also possible to file a complaint in certain situations. In these cases, please turn to the [Complaint Service Point \(https://www.maastrichtuniversity.nl/support/during-your-studies/complaints-service-point/filing-complaint\)](https://www.maastrichtuniversity.nl/support/during-your-studies/complaints-service-point/filing-complaint).

Student Code of Conduct

How do we wish to interact with each other? Here you will find a highlight of the values of the School of Business and Economics (SBE), which inspire our community and act as a framework for the personal conduct of employees and students:



01 Respect

First of all, we should be able to count on each other: among staff, among students, and in cooperation with each other. Respect, reliability, taking responsibility and self-reflection are the core concepts here. This includes, but is not limited to, the use of appropriate language in both written and spoken communication.

02 Commitment

We are part of a community of motivated students and staff. We expect students and staff to express their intellectual passion through ambition, initiative and commitment. Staff and students must encourage each other in this process.

03 Professionalism

Staff and students contribute to an inspiring work and academic climate from their various fields of expertise, knowledge and experience. We value each other's contribution in word and gesture. Students and employees have many rights as well as obligations and we acknowledge these and apply them appropriately and professionally at all times.

04 Inclusivity

Our School is dedicated to creating an inclusive environment for everyone, regardless of race, ethnicity, religion, colour, nationality, sexual orientation, gender etc. The inclusion of all students and staff members is fundamental to our School's diverse and international character. English is used as the lingua franca at all times within our School.

05 Integrity

We are committed to protecting and guaranteeing academic integrity. This means taking exams independently and honestly, indicating sources when writing a paper, essay or thesis and always being truthful when filling out forms and other documentation.

This Code of Conduct offers the possibility to hold someone accountable for undesirable behaviour. For more details, including complaint procedures and potential sanctions, please consult our full code of conduct via Student Portal>My Links>MySBE at <https://intranet.maastrichtuniversity.nl>.

Global Citizenship Education and Competency Development

*“The goal of Global Citizenship Education is to **empower learners** to engage and assume active roles, both **locally and globally**, to face and **resolve global challenges**, and ultimately to become **proactive contributors** to a more **just, peaceful, tolerant, inclusive, secure, and sustainable world**.” – UNESCO*

Why Global Citizenship Education throughout our curricula?

One of the most important callings for education in our time is to guide *your* personal development as a student in global citizenship to contribute meaningfully to perhaps the most serious, sweeping, and integrated set of challenges humanity has ever known.

As a graduate, you will face converging socio-ecological crises that permeate virtually all facets of human life and institutions, as well as the natural world. We also understand your need to find rewarding and well-compensated work in a world fraught with economic and employment instability, inequity, social division, and conflict. So, what’s our response?

Competence-based education for a better world

With Global Citizenship Education reflected in PBL tasks, assignments, study resources, and real-life transdisciplinary challenges beyond the university, we aim to help you develop the required competencies (knowledge, skills, and attitudes) to effectively navigate these unprecedented challenges—and to help you find your own role and purpose how to make the world a better place. It doesn’t matter where we begin. We all start small and *grow*.

Figure 1: Evolving framework for Global Citizenship Education at UM, listing **knowledge elements, skills, and attitudes** (plus other characteristics). Note that the dimensions are not mutually exclusive: an element may fit in more than one column.

Global literacy / Systems thinking	Social responsibility / Normative competence	Transformative engagement
understanding cultural world views; complex interdependency; history and futures literacy	understanding of social justice, power, citizenship, human rights, peace, (meta)ethics, sustainability	understanding (geo)politics, behaviour change, (digital) media
intercultural communication	moral/ethical reasoning	(glocal) participatory action
perspective-taking	personal responsibility	change agency
self-reflection	active listening	connecting and collaborating
complex problem solving	upstander skills	conflict resolution
critical thinking	emotion regulation	design thinking
commitment to inclusion	integrity	courage
respect	sense of purpose	trust
humility	fairness	resilience
curiosity	empathy	hope

These three pillars in *Figure 1* mark the UM framework for Global Citizenship Education, which forms the foundation underlying our educational programs, namely:

01 Global literacy/systems thinking is about understanding the complexity and uncertainty of our interrelated world and learning how to approach its challenges, while becoming more empathetic towards different cultural and historical perspectives and contexts.

02 Social responsibility can be seen as the perceived level of interdependence and social concern to others, to society, and to the environment. It relates to your personal development, search for meaning, developing a sense of purpose, and aspiration to contribute beyond the self.

03 Transformative engagement is about change agency, about translating your knowledge, attitudes, and skills into actions by designing, implementing, and evaluating (evidence-based) innovative solutions to wicked problems in co-creation with others.

We sincerely hope that through Global Citizenship Education, we will inspire you to initiate change within and outside of this course, to spark new discussions surrounding global citizenship related topics that are close to your heart, and to use your passion to *drive* positive change in whichever way you feel you can, and want to.

Always remember, a global citizen is a person developing an identity rooted in a particular community, but with a sense of connection and responsibility for people elsewhere. We hope to inspire that shared responsibility within you, and prepare you with the Global Citizenship competencies so that you may thrive in your personal and professional life. Will you answer the call and become a change agent for a better, more socially inclusive, environmentally sustainable, and equal world?

We all share that responsibility. The world depends upon you, on all of us. Let us start small. Let us grow together. Let us change the world!

For more information visit: <https://www.maastrichtuniversity.nl/global-citizenship-education/global-citizenship-education>

Support

An important aspect of being a student is figuring out your way of studying and dealing with (performance) pressure, perhaps also mental health struggles. However, it is important to remember that no two people have the exact same journey, but everyone has their own path. Along the way, it is possible that you will encounter certain obstacles, but know that you should not be afraid to ask for help and support, even if you just want to talk. You can start with talking to your peers who, no doubt, have similar experiences and struggles. However, there is also additional help available within and outside SBE.

SBE Student and Career Counselling is a good place to discuss about personal, academic and career related topics. Especially if you have a (mental) illness or if other personal circumstances affect your well-being and study, please make sure to contact them timely. It is a confidential setting and, when necessary, the counsellor can refer you to other support bodies, such as the [Maastricht University psychologists](https://www.maastrichtuniversity.nl/support/during-your-studies/student-guidance/psychological-support) (<https://www.maastrichtuniversity.nl/support/during-your-studies/student-guidance/psychological-support>), [student deans](https://www.maastrichtuniversity.nl/support/during-your-studies/student-guidance/um-student-deans) (<https://www.maastrichtuniversity.nl/support/during-your-studies/student-guidance/um-student-deans>) or [confidential advisors](https://www.maastrichtuniversity.nl/support/during-your-studies/student-guidance/confidential-advisor-students) (<https://www.maastrichtuniversity.nl/support/during-your-studies/student-guidance/confidential-advisor-students>). If you want to find out more about them, do not hesitate to visit the Intranet page of [SBE Student and Career Counselling](https://intranet.maastrichtuniversity.nl/en/school-business-and-economics-students/advice-support-and-counselling/sbe-student-career-counselling) (<https://intranet.maastrichtuniversity.nl/en/school-business-and-economics-students/advice-support-and-counselling/sbe-student-career-counselling>) (or via Student Portal>My Links>MySBE>Advice, Support and Counselling>SBE Student and Career Counselling). It is possible to make an appointment with them through their appointment system (<https://sbe-scc.maastrichtuniversity.nl/>).

If you are seeking psychological support, it is also possible to contact the Maastricht University psychologists. You can find more information via Student Portal>My Links>MySBE>Advice, Support and Counselling>Student Psychologists. You can book a Quick Psychological Referral via <https://www.maastrichtuniversity.nl/quick-psychological-referral>.

Lastly, for any course related questions, tutors and course coordinators are there to help. Bring your issue to your tutor first. If there is no resolution, course coordinators will provide the necessary support. For any study- or rule-related issue, you can access <https://esc.maastrichtuniversity.nl/>. When you submit a message via this platform, it will be matched to the office with relevant expertise to address your question.

Please remember: Studying sometimes means that you will struggle. However, it should not be suffering. Help is here if you need it. Please do not hesitate to ask.

Resources

Topic dependent.